



DITCH the stress

With the economic downturn biting deeper, all eyes have turned to the body's unrecognised ability to heal itself. This week, scientists from the University of Sussex, UK, validated what book-lovers have always

- Reading brings down stress levels by 68%
- Social work by 62%
- Listening to music: 61%
- Drinking a cup of tea or coffee: 54%
- Taking a walk: 42%
- Anticipating a good laugh: 39%
- A good shout: 25%
- Playing video games: 21%
- Chewing gum: 17%

known: that reading is the best way to relax. You can read any book. And even six minutes is enough to cut stress by more than two-thirds. This is because the mind has to concentrate on reading and the distraction of being taken into an imaginary world eases the tensions in muscles and the heart. If you have let your reading slide because you are just too busy, it's time to pick up a book again.

How much do you drink?

Experts report new patterns of alcohol abuse in India

Officially, India is among the bottom 15% in per capita alcohol consumption

But drinkers below age 21 have gone up (2 to 14%) in 15 years, with age of initiation dipping

Number of women drinkers rising, from 3.2% in 1981 to 10% now

Binge drinking or solitary intoxication afflicts half of those who drink

Alcohol accounts for over a fifth of hospital admissions and three-fifths of all injuries

Number of doctors trained to treat alcohol abuse in the past decade is quite low



A NEW MODEL FOR MEDICAL EMERGENCIES

Rapid Rescue Services has launched the first paid emergency medical facility across New Delhi and Gurgaon. In case of an emergency, a customer needs to press the registered number to get in touch with the team. With a fleet of doctors and paramedics, equipped with bikes, GPS and blue beacons, the RRS teams promise to reach within 30 minutes. For more on membership details, call 0124 4748500 or toll free number 1800 102 3005, or write in: mail@rapidrescueservices.com.



Join the fight against multiple sclerosis



It's one of the least understood and most under-reported health issues. Yet multiple sclerosis (MS)—the dreaded disorder of the central nervous system—happens to be the most common neurological affliction among adults between the age of 20 and 40, with over 40,000 cases in India. There is, however, just one support organisation in the country for MS patients. The Multiple Sclerosis Society of India has just turned 20 and is gearing up to celebrate not just its anniversary but also the first World MS Day on May 27. If you wish to join the global movement to fight MS, want to know more or make a donation, do write in (mssi_delhi@rediffmail.com) or ring: 9811012334/ 09312210645.

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